ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 62

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

# My First Swahili Alphabet

## Alfabeti yangu ya kwanza ya Kiswahili

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 30 Swahili Letters with English Phonetics

A a B b D d

**Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza**

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah**

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

**REVIEW DRAFT — DO NOT PUBLISH YET.** The letter names, sound guides, words, transliterations and phrases in this book were drafted with AI and have not yet been checked by a native speaker. After review, set `draft=False` in the language file and rebuild; this notice then disappears.

**My First Swahili Alphabet** — Alfabeti yangu ya kwanza ya Kiswahili
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 62

Text copyright © 2026 Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza. All rights reserved.
No part of this book may be reproduced, stored or shared in any form without written permission from the publisher, except that parents and teachers may copy pages for use with their own children or class.

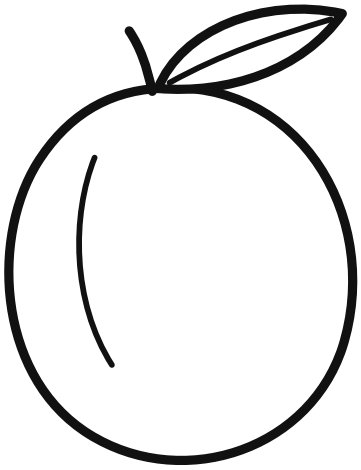
Published by **Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** (مكتبة كنوز الآخرة),
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust, Bangladesh.
Contact: minhaz.reza87@gmail.com

First edition, 2026.

**Illustrations:** line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

**Fonts:** Baloo 2, Noto Sans, Fredoka, Nunito, Amiri and Dancing Script, all under the SIL Open Font License.
**Map data:** Natural Earth (public domain).

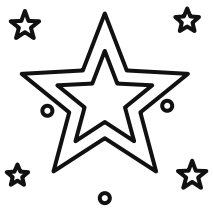
**A note of respect:** this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.



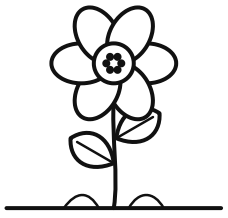
# This book belongs to

## Kitabu hiki ni cha

I started learning Swahili on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

# The Allamahul Bayan Series

## عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

*ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"*

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

*Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.*

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

**Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4**[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

**What does *al-bayān* mean?** It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

# Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

*Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.*

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

**Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22**[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

*Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.*

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

**Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)**[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

### How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

**Book 62 is Swahili**. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

# How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

**Marker tip:** every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

### Reading the English sound guides

- **CAPITALS** show the stressed syllable: *a-SA-lee* means "say SA a little louder". In Swahili the stress is almost always on the next-to-last syllable.
- **m-** and **n-** at the start of a word are said as a short hum: *m-see-KEE-tee*.
- **gh** is a soft gargle in the throat; **th** is "think", **dh** is "this".
- Every vowel is said on its own: *ua* is two beats, *OO-a*.

### Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Swahili name** written in Swahili (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. The box marked *Swahili name · syllables* shows the name Swahili children use for the letter (B is «be», CH is «che») and its row of syllables — the way Swahili is taught in school.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Standard Swahili (Kiswahili sanifu) as taught in Tanzania and Kenya.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

# Hello, Swahili! Kiswahili

*kee-swa-HEE-lee — the Swahili word for the language*

**Who speaks it?**
More than **70 million people** speak Swahili — most of them learn it as a second language, so people from many different families can talk together.[3]

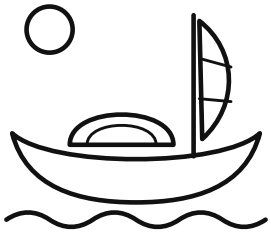
**Where?**
Along the **East African coast** and far inland: in **Tanzania**, **Kenya**, **Uganda**, the eastern **Congo** and nearby lands, and on islands such as **Zanzibar**.

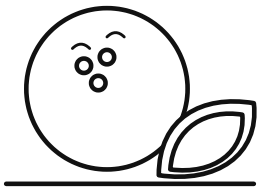
**How is it written?**
In the **Latin alphabet**, from **left to right**. For hundreds of years before that, Swahili poems and letters were written in **Arabic letters**.

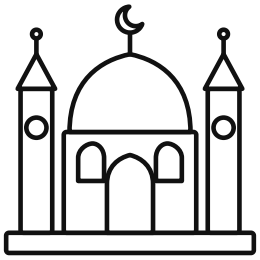
**How many letters?**
**24 letters**, plus **letter pairs** such as *sh*, *ny* and *ng'* for special sounds.

**A name from the coast**
The name *Swahili* comes from the Arabic word *sawāḥil*, "coasts". It began as the language of the seaside towns!

**Did you know?**
Many Swahili words come from Arabic: *kitabu* (book, from *kitāb*), *msikiti* (mosque, from *masjid*), *dunia* (world) and *saa* (hour, clock).







# The Swahili Alphabet alfabeti

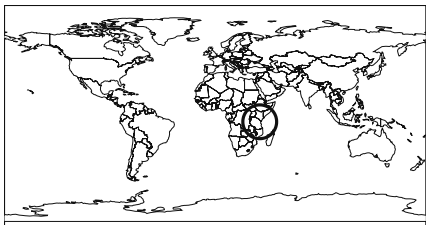
## 24 letters — herufi za Kiswahili

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Aa** *ah* | **Bb** *beh* | **Ch ch** *cheh* | **Dd** *deh* | **Ee** *eh* | **Ff** *feh* |
| **Gg** *geh* | **Hh** *heh* | **Ii** *ee* | **Jj** *jeh* | **Kk** *keh* | **Ll** *leh* |
| **Mm** *meh* | **Nn** *neh* | **Oo** *oh* | **Pp** *peh* | **Rr** *reh* | **Ss** *seh* |
| **Tt** *teh* | **Uu** *oo* | **Vv** *veh* | **Ww** *weh* | **Yy** *yeh* | **Zz** *zeh* |

## 6 letter pairs — herufi mbili

| | | | | | |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Dh dh** *thah* | **Gh gh** *ghah* | **Ng' ng'** *ngah* | **Ny ny** *nyah* | **Sh sh** *shah* | **Th th** *thah* |

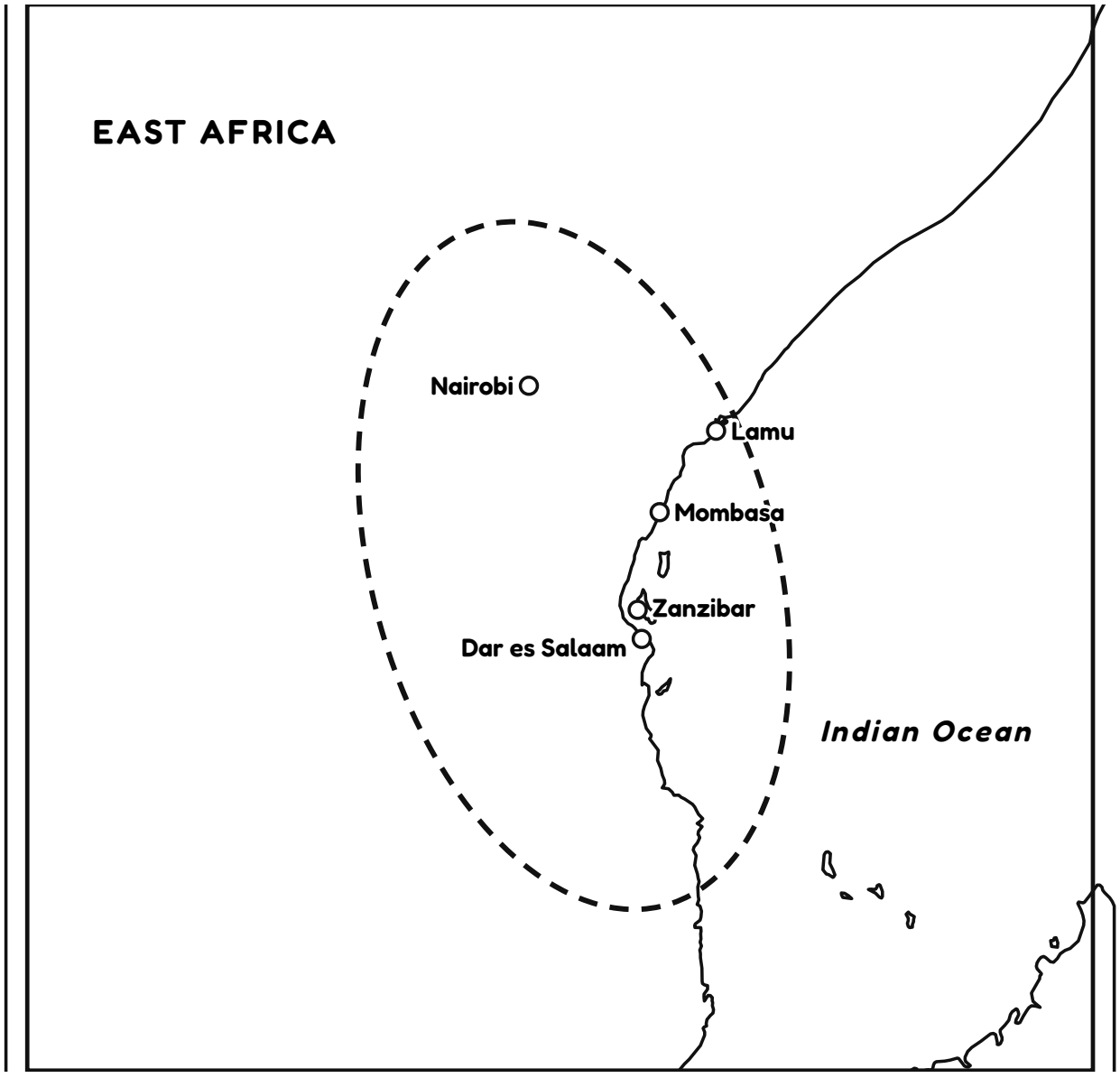
Read the alphabet row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows East Africa on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

# Where is Swahili spoken?




**Color it:** the land **green** · the ocean **blue**. **Find it:** Swahili is spoken in Lamu, Mombasa, Zanzibar, Dar es Salaam, Nairobi and all across East Africa. The dashed line shows where most Swahili speakers live.

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

THE LETTERS

# The Letters herufi za Kiswahili

*heh-ROO-fee za kee-swa-HEE-lee — “the Swahili letters”*

Swahili is written with **24 letters**. It has no Q and no X, and C is only used in the pair **ch**.

**Easy to read aloud**
Swahili is written just as it sounds. Every letter is said — there are no silent letters — and almost every word ends with a vowel.

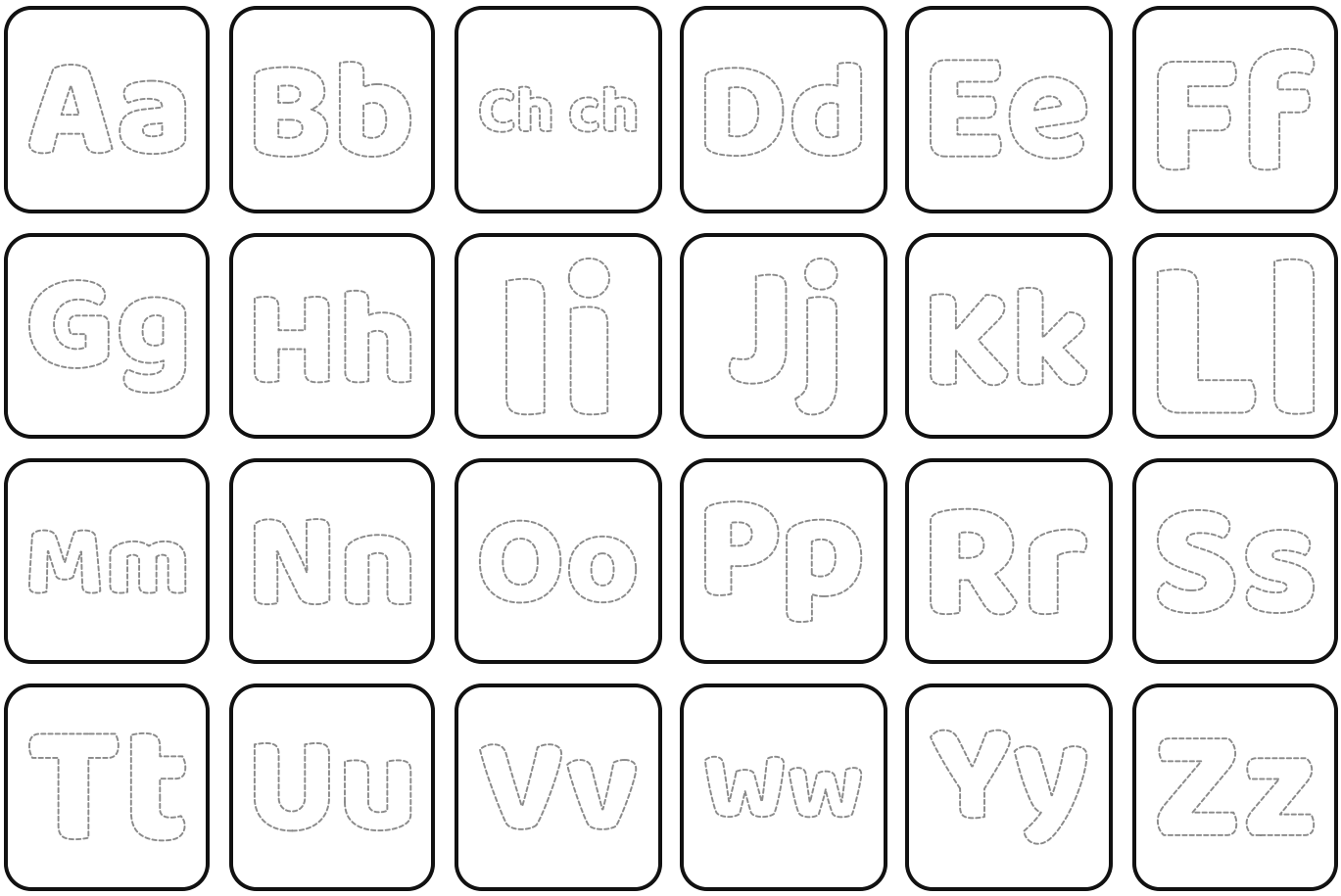
**Five pure vowels**
**A E I O U** always say *ah, eh, ee, oh, oo*. Swahili children learn to read by singing the syllables: *ba be bi bo bu, cha che chi cho chu…*

**Big and small**
Each page shows the **capital letter** and the **small letter** side by side: **Aa**. Color both!

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the letters herufi za Kiswahili

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.



# Aa

**NAME · JINA**

**a**

*ah*

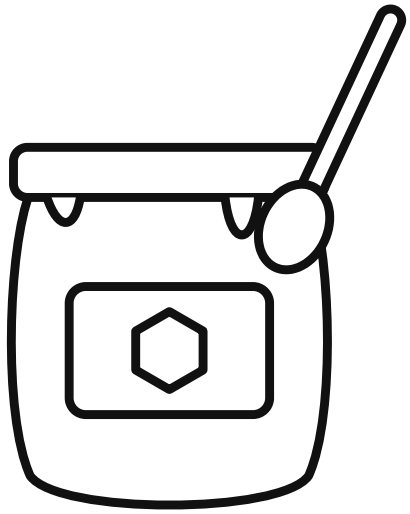
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘a’ as in “father”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

A a — «a»

ba · da · ka · ma · na



AA **IS FOR**

## asali

*a-SA-lee*

**honey**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Aa Aa Aa Aa

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Bb

**NAME · JINA**

## be

*beh*

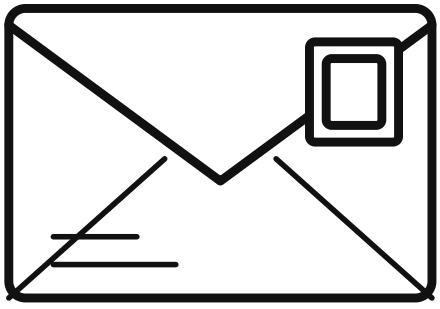
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘b’ as in “ball”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

B b — «be»

ba · be · bi · bo · bu



**BB IS FOR**

## barua

*ba-ROO-a*

**a letter to post**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Bb Bb Bb Bb

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ch ch

**NAME · JINA**

## che

*cheh*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ch’ as in “church”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Ch ch — «che»

cha · che · chi · cho · chu

Swahili uses C only together with H: **ch**.



**CH CH IS FOR**

## chai

*CHA-ee*

**tea**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch Ch ch

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Dd

**NAME · JINA**

**de**

*deh*

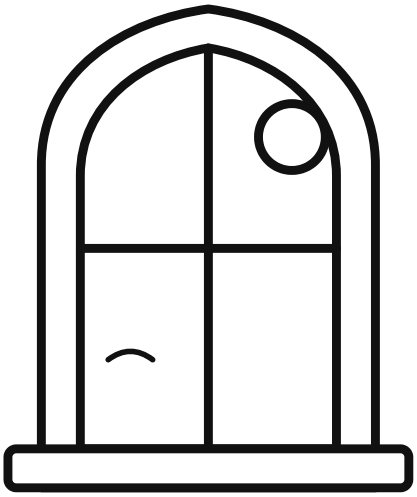
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘d’ as in “door”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

D d — «de»

da · de · di · do · du



**DD IS FOR**

## dirisha

*dee-REE-sha*

**window**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Dd Dd Dd Dd

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ee

**NAME · JINA**

**e**

*eh*

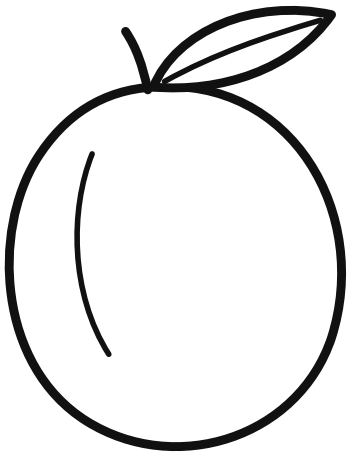
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘e’ as in “bed”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

E e — «e»

be · de · ke · me · ne



**EE IS FOR**

## embe

*EM-beh*

**mango**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ee Ee Ee Ee

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ff

**NAME · JINA**

**fe**

*feh*

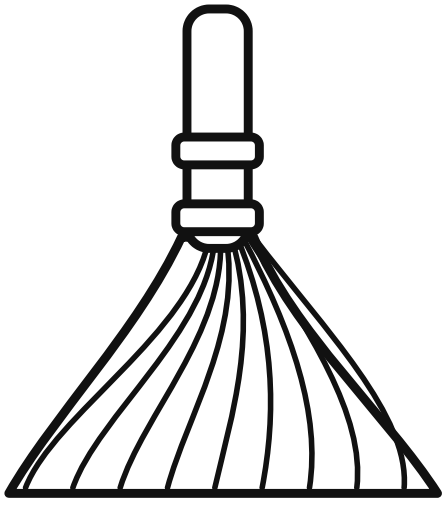
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘f’ as in “fan”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

F f — «fe»

fa · fe · fi · fo · fu



**FF IS FOR**

## fagio

*fa-GEE-o*

**broom**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ff Ff Ff Ff

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Gg

**NAME · JINA**

**ge**

*geh*

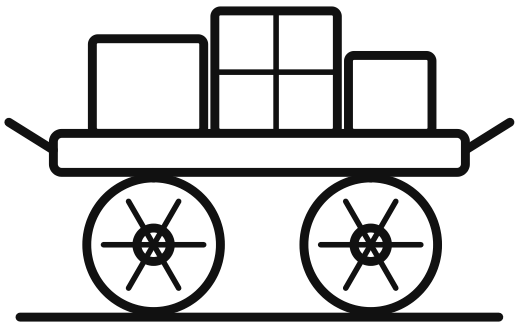
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘g’ as in “go” (always hard)

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

G g — «ge»

ga · ge · gi · go · gu



**GG IS FOR**

## gari

*GA-ree*

**cart, car (anything with wheels)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Gg Gg Gg Gg

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Hh

**NAME · JINA**

**he**

*heh*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘h’ as in “hat”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

H h — «he»

ha · he · hi · ho · hu



**HH IS FOR**

## hilali

*hee-LA-lee*

**new crescent moon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Hh Hh Hh Hh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

ii

**NAME · JINA**

**i**

*ee*

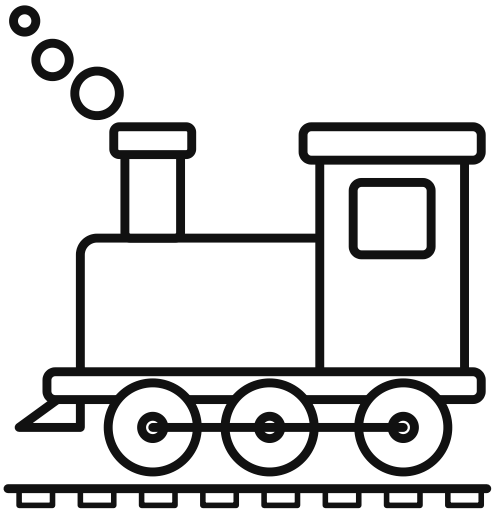
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ee’ as in “see”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

| i — «i»

bi · di · ki · mi · ni



**II IS FOR**

# injini

*een-JEE-nee*

**engine**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

ii ii ii ii

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Jj

**NAME · JINA**

**je**

*jeh*

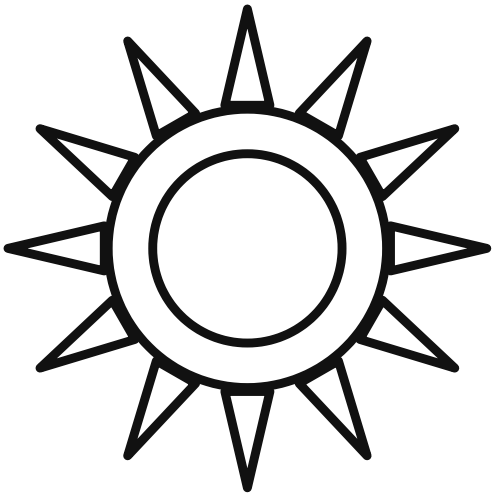
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘j’ as in “jam”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

J j — «je»

ja · je · ji · jo · ju



**JJ IS FOR**

**jua**

*JOO-a*

**sun**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Jj Jj Jj Jj

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Kk

**NAME · JINA**

**ke**

*keh*

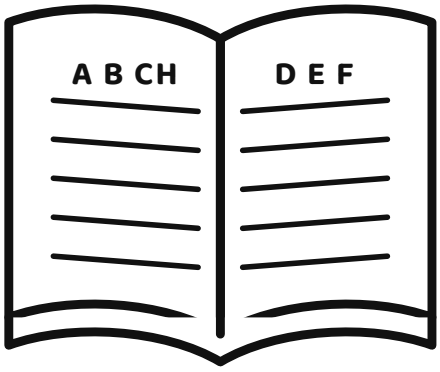
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘k’ as in “kite”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

K k — «ke»

ka · ke · ki · ko · ku




**KK IS FOR**

## kitabu

*kee-TA-boo*

**book**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Kk Kk Kk Kk

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

Ll

**NAME · JINA**

**le**

*leh*

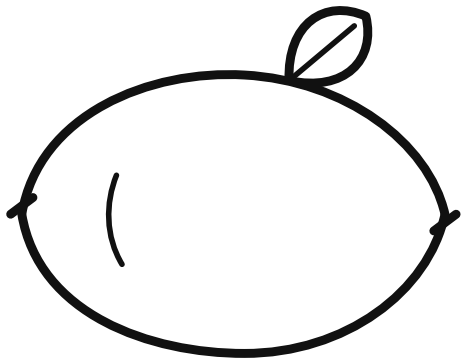
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

'l' as in "lamp"

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

L l — «le»

la · le · li · lo · lu



**LL IS FOR**

# limau

*lee-MA-oo*

**lemon**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ll Ll Ll Ll

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Mm

**NAME · JINA**

**me**

*meh*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

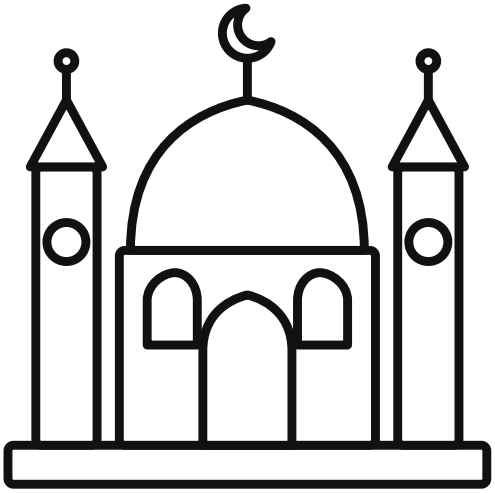
‘m’ as in “moon”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

M m — «me»

ma · me · mi · mo · mu

M can be a whole syllable on its own: *m-si-ki-ti*.



**MM IS FOR**

## msikiti

*m-see-KEE-tee*

**mosque**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Mm Mm Mm Mm

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Nn

**NAME · JINA**

**ne**

*neh*

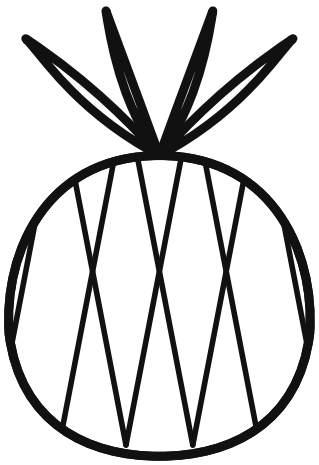
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘n’ as in “net”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

N n — «ne»

na · ne · ni · no · nu



**NN IS FOR**

## nanasi

*na-NA-see*

**pineapple**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Nn Nn Nn Nn

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Oo

**NAME · JINA**

**o**

*oh*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

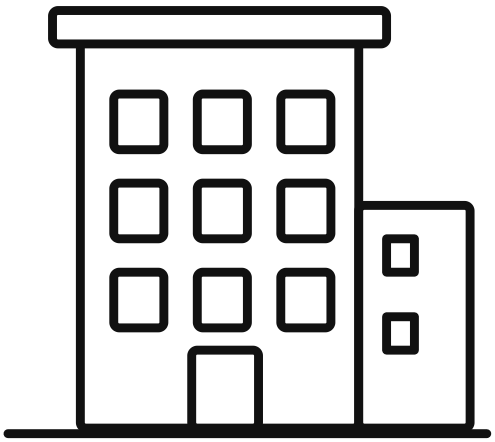
‘o’ as in “more” (short and pure)

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

O o — «o»

bo · do · ko · mo · no

Not many Swahili words start with O, but O is in almost every sentence!



**OO IS FOR**

## orofa

*o-RO-fa*

**a tall building with floors**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Oo Oo Oo Oo

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Pp

**NAME · JINA**

**pe**

*peh*

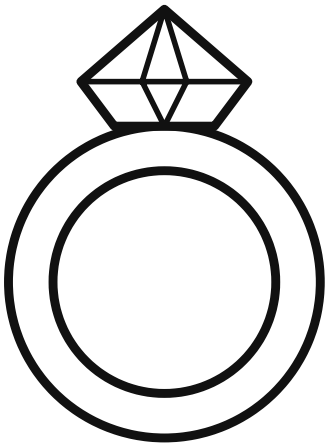
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘p’ as in “pen”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

P p — «pe»

pa · pe · pi · po · pu



**PP IS FOR**

**pete**

*PEH-teh*

**ring**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Pp Pp Pp Pp

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Rr

**NAME · JINA**

**re**

*reh*

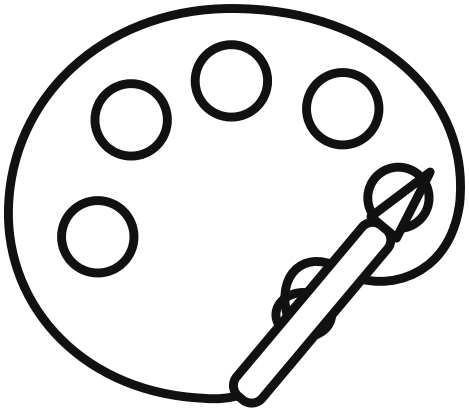
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a quick tapped ‘r’

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

R r — «re»

ra · re · ri · ro · ru



**RR IS FOR**

## rangi

*RA-ngee*

**colors, paint**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Rr Rr Rr Rr

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ss

**NAME · JINA**

**se**

*seh*

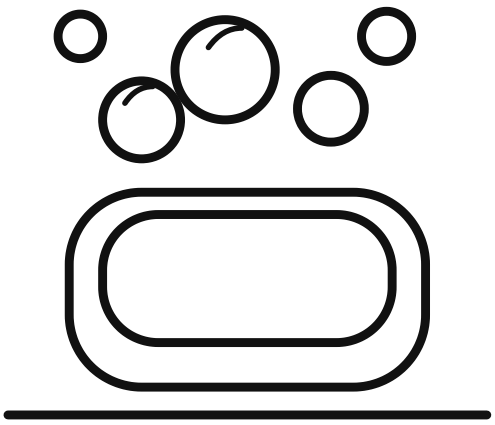
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘s’ as in “sun”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

S s — «se»

sa · se · si · so · su



**SS IS FOR**

## sabuni

*sa-BOO-nee*

**soap**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ss Ss Ss Ss

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Tt

**NAME · JINA**

**te**

*teh*

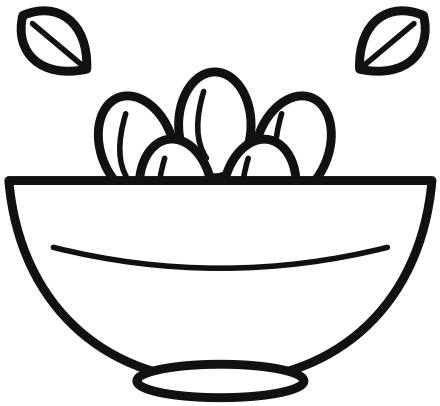
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘t’ as in “tap”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

T t — «te»

ta · te · ti · to · tu



**TT IS FOR**

## tende

*TEH-ndeh*

**dates**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Tt Tt Tt Tt

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Uu

**NAME · JINA**

**u**

*oo*

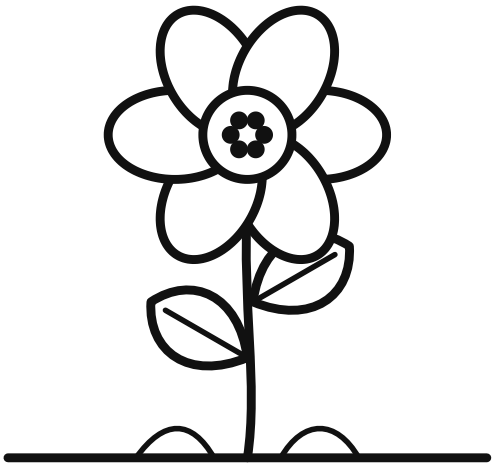
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘oo’ as in “moon”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

U u — «u»

bu · du · ku · mu · nu



**UU IS FOR**

**ua**

*OO-a*

**flower**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Uu Uu Uu Uu

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Vv

**NAME · JINA**

**ve**

*veh*

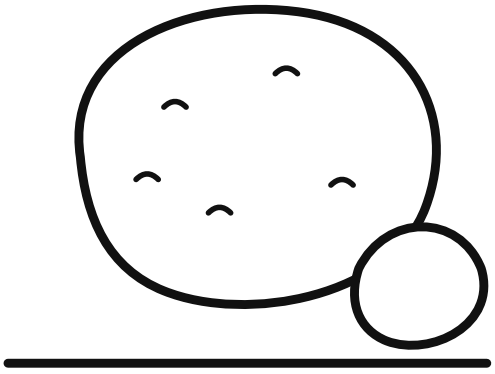
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘v’ as in “van”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

V v — «ve»

va · ve · vi · vo · vu



**VV IS FOR**

## viazi

*vee-A-zee*

**potatoes**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Vv Vv Vv Vv

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ww

**NAME · JINA**

**we**

*weh*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘w’ as in “water”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

W w — «we»

wa · we · wi · wo · wu



WW **IS FOR**

## wali

*WA-lee*

**cooked rice**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ww Ww Ww Ww

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Yy

**NAME · JINA**

**ye**

*yeh*

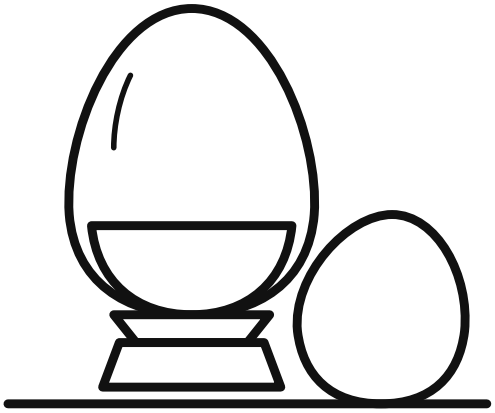
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘y’ as in “yes”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Y y — «ye»

ya · ye · yi · yo · yu



**YY IS FOR**

## yai

*YA-ee*

**egg**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Yy Yy Yy Yy

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Zz

**NAME · JINA**

**ze**

*zeh*

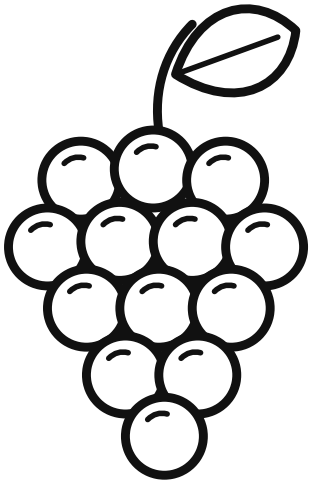
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘z’ as in “zoo”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Z z — «ze»

za · ze · zi · zo · zu



**ZZ IS FOR**

## zabibu

*za-BEE-boo*

**grapes**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Zz Zz Zz Zz

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LETTER PAIRS

# Letter Pairs herufi mbili

*heh-ROO-fee m-BEE-lee — “two letters”*

Some Swahili sounds are written with **two letters together**. You already know one of them: **ch**.

**Six more pairs**
**dh · gh · ng’ · ny · sh · th** — each pair makes **one** sound. Many of these sounds came into Swahili with words from Arabic.

**Watch the little mark!**
**ng’** (with the mark) sounds like the end of “sing”; **ng** (no mark) sounds like the middle of “finger”.

PENCIL WARM-UP

# Trace the letter pairs herufi mbili

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Dh dh | Gh gh | Ng' ng' |
| Ny ny | Sh sh | Th th |

# Dh dh

**NAME · JINA**

## dha

*thah*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘th’ as in “this” (buzzy)

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Dh dh — «dha»

dha · dhe · dhi · dho · dhu



**DH DH IS FOR**

## dhoruba

*tho-ROO-ba*

**storm**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh Dh dh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Gh gh

**NAME · JINA**

## gha

*ghah*

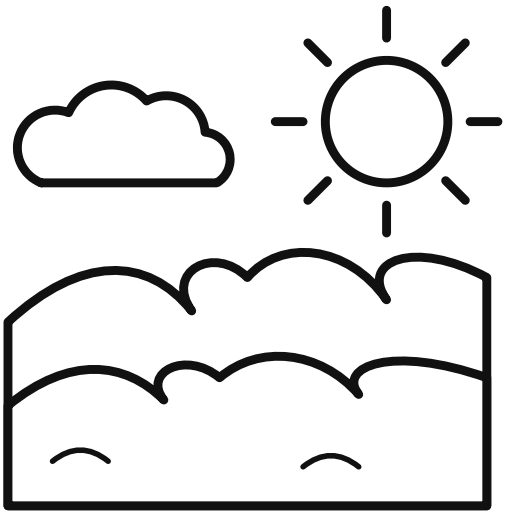
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

a soft gargled ‘g’ from the back of the throat, like Arabic غ

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Gh gh — «gha»

gha · ghe · ghi · gho · ghu



**GH GH IS FOR**

## ghuba

*GHOO-ba*

**bay (where the sea curves into the land)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh Gh gh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ng’ ng’

**NAME · JINA**

## ng’a

*ngah*

**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ng’ as in “sing” — but Swahili can start a word with it!

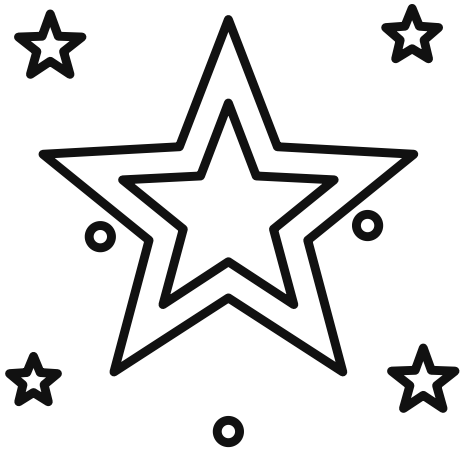
**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Ng’ ng’ — «ng’a»

ng’a · ng’e · ng’i · ng’o · ng’u

ng’ (with the mark) = “si**ng**” · ng (no mark) = “fi**ng**er”

Ng’ hardly ever starts a word you can draw. Find it inside *kung’aa*!



**NG’ NG’ IS FOR**

## kung’aa

*koo-NGA-a*

**to shine, to sparkle**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’ Ng’ ng’

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Ny ny

**NAME · JINA**

## nya

*nyah*

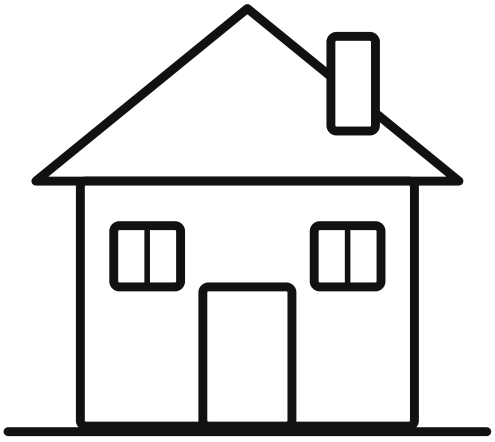
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘ny’ as in “canyon”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Ny ny — «nya»

nya · nye · nyi · nyo · nyu



**NY NY IS FOR**

## nyumba

*NYOO-mba*

**house**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny Ny ny

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Sh sh

**NAME · JINA**

## sha

*shah*

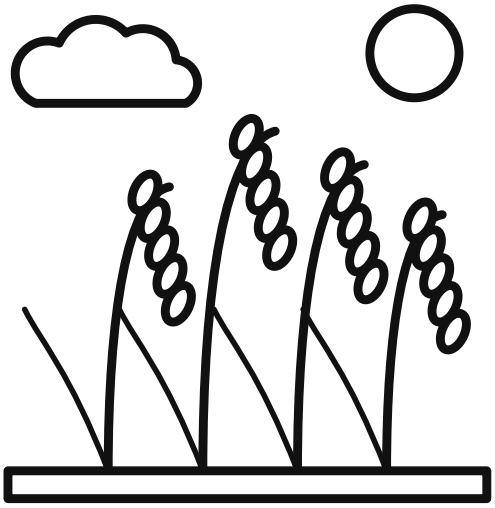
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘sh’ as in “ship”

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Sh sh — «sha»

sha · she · shi · sho · shu



**SH SH IS FOR**

## shamba

*SHA-mba*

**farm, field**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh Sh sh

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

# Th th

**NAME · JINA**

## tha

*thah*

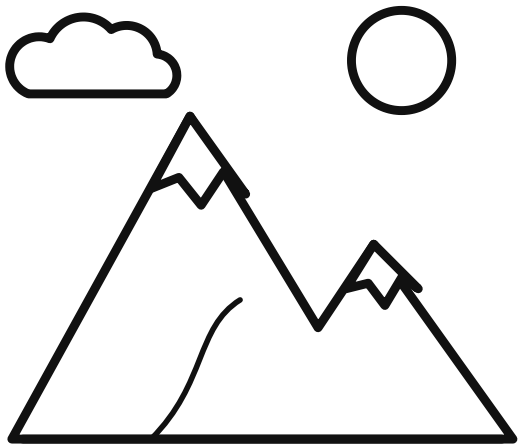
**SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE**

‘th’ as in “think” (soft)

**SWAHILI NAME · SYLLABLES**

Th th — «tha»

tha · the · thi · tho · thu



**TH TH IS FOR**

## theluji

*theh-LOO-jee*

**snow (on a mountain top)**

Color the picture and say the word three times!

**TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · ANDIKA**

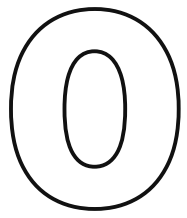
Th th Th th Th th Th th

This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

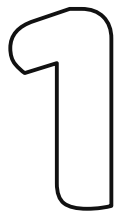
BONUS

# Swahili numbers nambari *(nam-BA-ree)*

Color the numbers and count out loud in Swahili: *see-FOO-ree, MO-ja, m-BEE-lee, TA-too...*



**0**
**sifuri**
*see-FOO-ree*
zero



**1**
**moja**
*MO-ja*
one



**2**
**mbili**
*m-BEE-lee*
two



**3**
**tatu**
*TA-too*
three



**4**
**nne**
*N-neh*
four



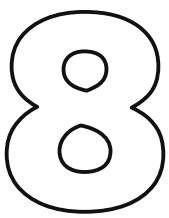
**5**
**tano**
*TA-no*
five



**6**
**sita**
*SEE-ta*
six



**7**
**saba**
*SA-ba*
seven



**8**
**nane**
*NA-neh*
eight



**9**
**tisa**
*TEE-sa*
nine

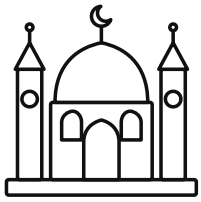
This page is left blank on purpose, so your colours don’t bleed through. ✿

LET'S TALK

# My first Swahili words Maneno ya kwanza

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

| | |
|---|---|
| **Assalamu alaikum** | *as-sa-LA-moo a-LAY-koom*<br>**Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)** |
| **Waalaikum salaam** | *wa-a-LAY-koom sa-LAAM*<br>**And peace be upon you (the reply)** |
| **Hujambo? · Sijambo!** | *hoo-JA-mbo · see-JA-mbo*<br>**How are you? · I am fine!** |
| **Jina langu ni ...** | *JEE-na LA-ngoo nee ...*<br>**My name is ...** |
| **Asante** | *a-SA-nteh*<br>**Thank you** |
| **Jazakallahu khairan** | *ja-za-KAL-la-hoo KHAI-ran*<br>**May Allah reward you with good** |
| **mama · baba** | *MA-ma · BA-ba*<br>**Mother · Father** |
| **kaka · dada** | *KA-ka · DA-da*<br>**Brother · Sister** |
| **ndiyo · hapana** | *n-DEE-yo · ha-PA-na*<br>**Yes · No** |
| **Ninajifunza Kiswahili!** | *nee-na-jee-FOO-nza kee-swa-HEE-lee*<br>**I am learning Swahili!** |







REFERENCES & SOURCES

# Where our facts come from

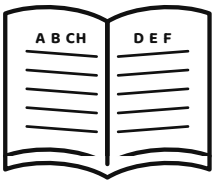
[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

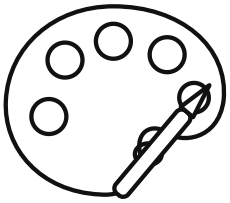
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

**What's next?**
You have met all **30 Swahili letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Swahili, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

**Enjoyed this book?**
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*





# Certificate of Achievement

## Mashallah! Hongera!

*MA-sha-la! ho-NGEH-ra! — Mashallah! Well done!*

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
**all 30 letters of the Swahili alphabet**.

_____ Date

_____ Grown-up's signature

*Minhaz Reza*

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

**Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah** — Publisher
An imprint of the Kunujul Akhirah Charitable Trust
مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

✂ Cut out and frame it — the back of this page is blank.